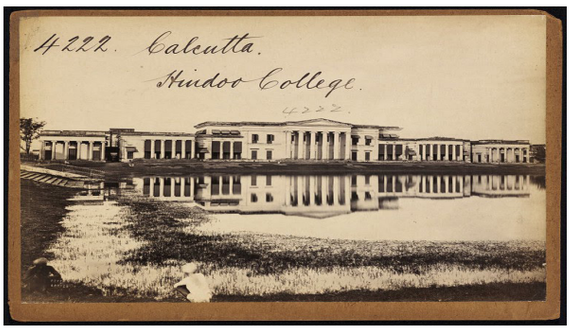
provide liberal education in English language. The Christian missionaries making use of their freedom on their part opened a Baptist Mission College in the following year (1818) at Serampore. Raja Rammohan Roy pleaded for more 'enlightened system of education in which mathematics, philosophy, chemistry, anatomy and other useful sciences would be included'.



The Hindu College, Calcutta

English Education

Noting that the cultured classes were desirous of English education, William Bentinck on his appointment as Governor General of India appointed Thomas Babington Macaulay to be the chairman of the then existing Education Committee to recommend a definite policy on education to be adopted. Macaulay prepared his famous Minute of 1835. According to this Minute the objective of the government's educational policy was to be 'the promotion of European literature and science among the natives of India'. It was also clearly stated that the medium of language to be used was English. Bentinck endorsed Macaulay's Minute and decided that the Education fund henceforth should be spent on English education alone.

Wood's Despatch



Charles Wood

The Company's charter renewal came up in 1852 and this provided occasion for the British Parliament to take a definite decision on education. The new educational policy statement was sent in the famous Charles Wood's Despatch of 1854. The Wood's Despatch reiterated what had been stated in Macaulay's famous Minute of 1835. Though there were protests from orthodox sections of Indians, the government went ahead with its policy and founded a university in each of the three presidencies. University education started with the setting up at Madras, Bombay and Calcutta universities modelled on the then University of London in 1857. The main function was to hold examination and to confer degrees on successful candidates appearing from affiliated colleges. The University in each Presidency prescribed the courses and the syllabi.

Christian Missionaries and Education

Bengal

The contribution of Christian missionaries to education was praiseworthy. A Bengal elementary school was started by Baptist missionaries with forty boys at Serampore in 1800. This was followed by establishment of a number of schools in the presidency by London Missionary Society. European missionaries showed more interest than the government in Indian women's progress. Miss Mary Ann Cook on her arrival in India in 1821 established 23 girl schools with an average of 25 to 30 students in each in Calcutta and the surrounding villages. Another notable event was the establishment of the Bethune School (1849) at Calcutta by John Elliot Drinkwater Bethune. This school later taken over by the government after his death and it became the first institution of higher education for women in 1879.

Bombay

The American Society established school for girls in 1824 with the objective of educationg the daughters of soldiers. Dr. and Mrs. Wilson founded six girls schools in Bombay during the year 1829-'30. Jyotiba Phule opened a pioneering school (1848) for girls of the historically marginalised sections of the society in Pune. In 1889 Professor Karve of Poona started a school for Hindu widows. This developed into the Women's

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